

KEY

ATHENS

City-states

Individual Greek cities ruled themselves and had their own armies.



Merchant routes

Greek merchants sailed the seas, carrying goods such as olive oil.



Sea battles

Warships were rowed into battle, using battering rams to sink enemy ships.



Greek games

Athletic contests were held in religious centers, such as Olympia.

Many cities

Ancient Greece was a collection of city-states. The Greeks traveled and founded cities all over the Mediterranean.



SCALE

0 50 miles
0 50 kilometers

Far and wide

The Greeks founded settlements all around the Mediterranean and the Black Sea. The best surviving Greek temples are not in Greece but in Italy. This one is in Sicily.



Temple of Segesta, built c.420 BCE



NAPLES

PAESTUM

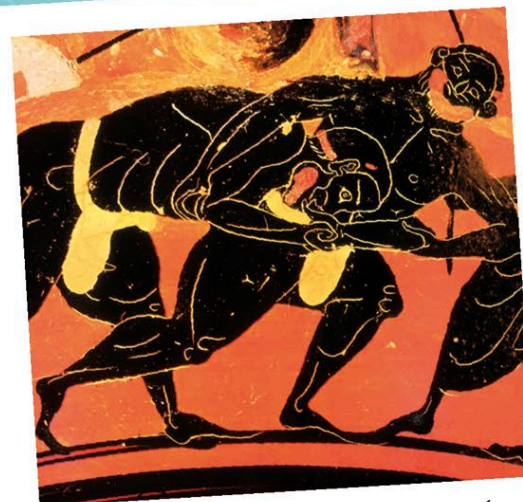
SYRACUSE

ADRIATIC SEA

IONIAN SEA

The Olympic Games

The Greeks invented athletic competitions. The most famous was held at Olympia during a festival in honor of Zeus, king of the gods. Athletes came from all over the Greek world.



Wrestling in the Greek Olympics

Ancient Greece

The ancient Greeks were some of the most creative people in history. They invented theater, sports, politics, science, and the writing of history. Their beautiful art and architecture is still copied today. Ancient Greek civilization was at its height between 500 and 300 BCE.